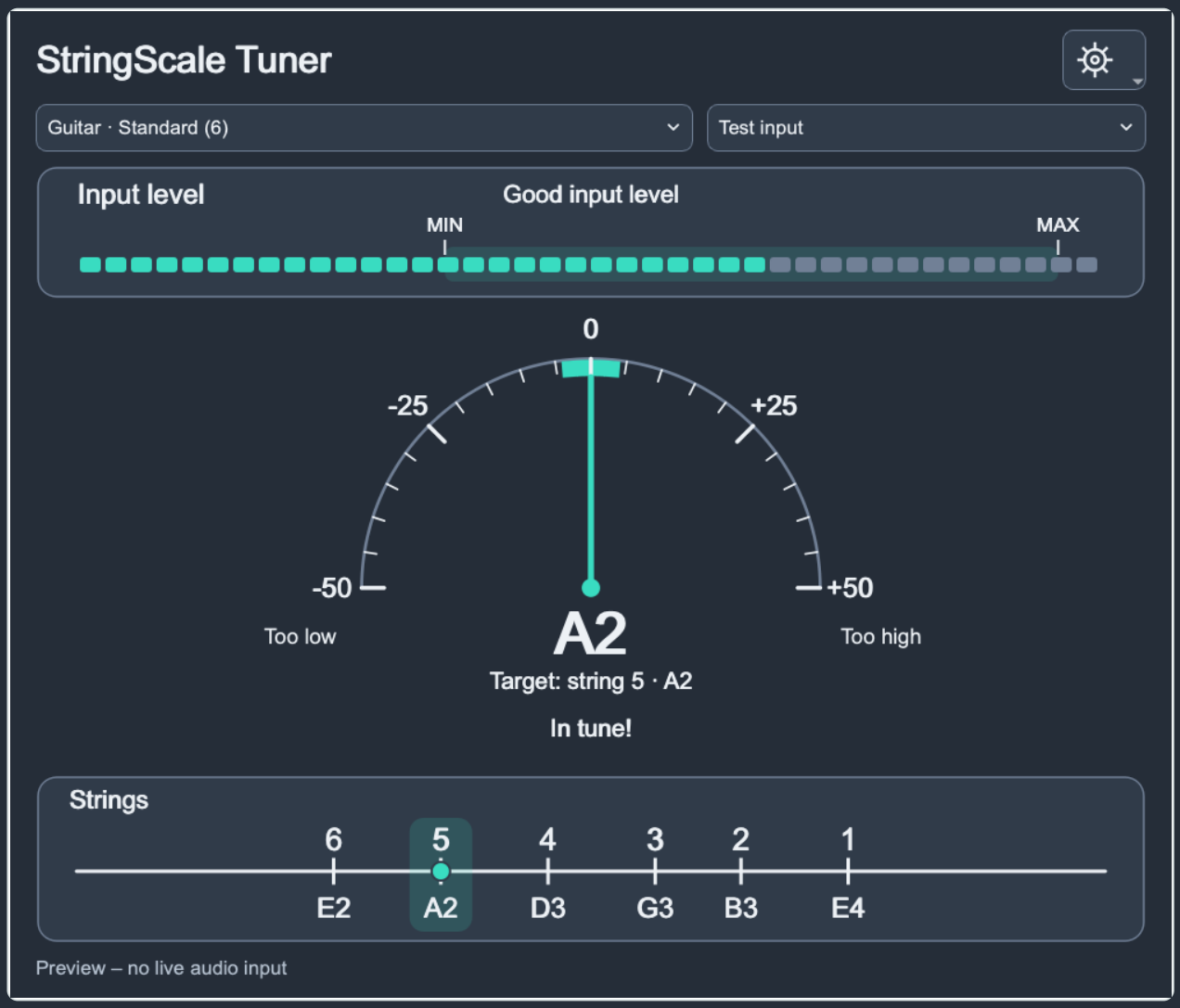
STRINGSCALE TUNER

User manual

Installation and tuning, step by step



WINDOWS x64 / macOS APPLE SILICON

English edition • 0.2.0-alpha.1

Document date: 4 November 2026 • RobCZart82

Images show application previews, not live audio measurements.

01 / WINDOWS X64

Install on Windows

EXE or ZIP?

Use the EXE for installation. The project also provides a separate ZIP preview.
For the ZIP, follow the instructions at the bottom of this page.

1

Download the Windows x64 package

Use the official GitHub project page and choose Windows x64. When an installer is available, download the EXE file.

2

Start the installer

Double-click the EXE. Windows may warn about a new unsigned release. Approve a system permission request only for the download you intended to install.

3

If SmartScreen shows a warning

After checking the trusted source: More info → Run anyway, if available. If device policy blocks it, ask your administrator.

4

Follow the installation steps

Follow the prompts, then launch StringScale Tuner from the location shown by the installer. Exact buttons depend on the installer edition.

Starting the current ZIP preview

Extract the download, then the versioned ZIP inside it. Run bin/StringScaleTuner.exe; keep the DLLs and subfolders alongside it. No Qt, CMake or Visual Studio installation is required.

02 / MACOS APPLE SILICON

Install on macOS

Use the PKG for installation on a Mac with Apple Silicon. For a ZIP preview, follow the instructions at the bottom of this page.

1

Open the PKG file

Download macOS Apple Silicon from the official project page, then double-click the PKG.

2

If the developer cannot be verified

Choose Cancel / Done in the warning. Open System Settings → Privacy & Security.

3

Allow this installer

In the Security section, select Open Anyway if shown. Authenticate, then confirm with Open.

4

Install, then launch the app

Follow Installer. Launch StringScale Tuner from Applications when installed there. The app itself may require a separate approval on first launch.

5

Allow microphone access

Allow StringScale Tuner to receive audio. This may also be required for an external guitar interface. If denied: Privacy & Security → Microphone.

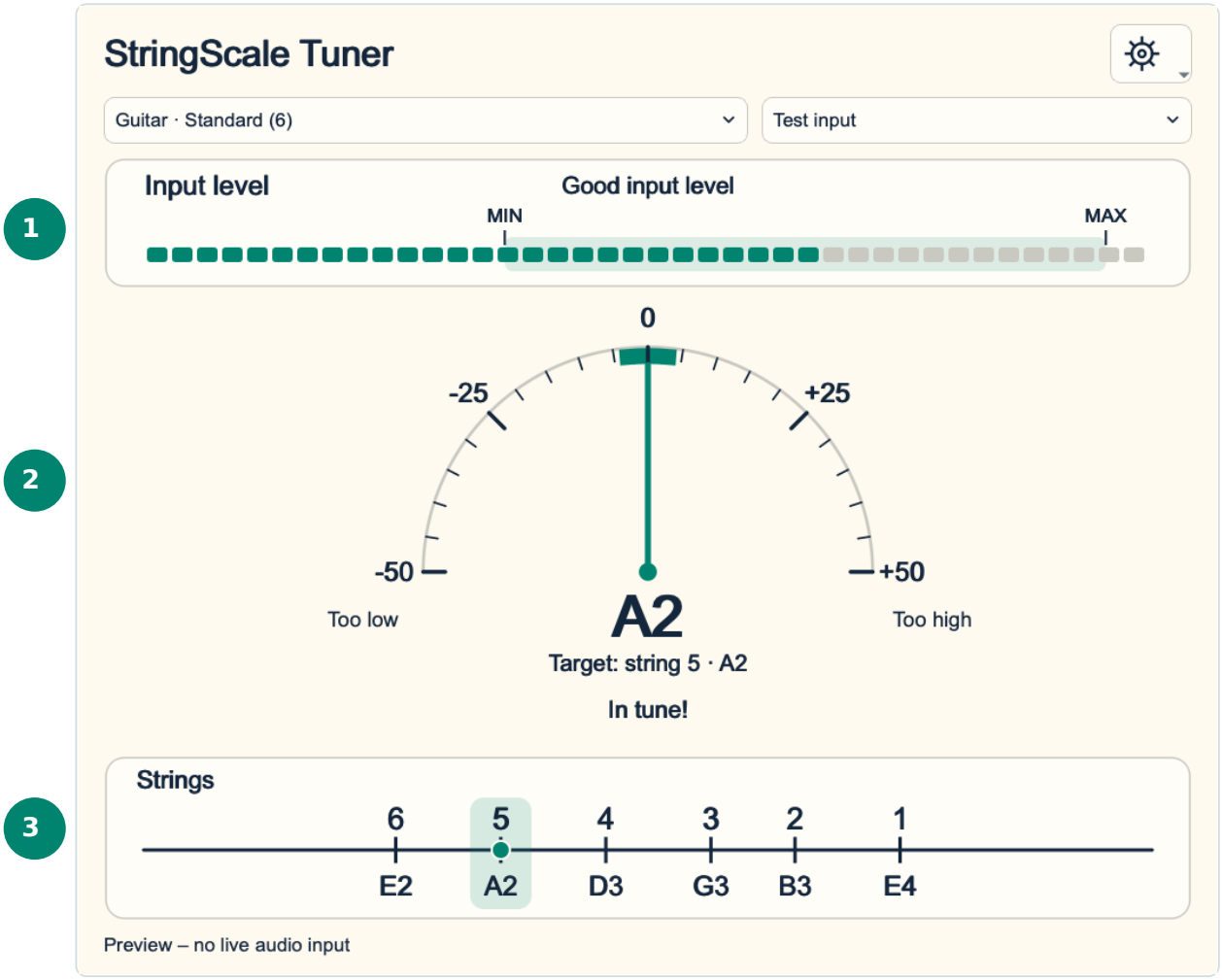
ZIP package and macOS warnings

For a ZIP, extract the app and copy it to Applications. Ad-hoc signing is not Apple notarization. Button labels vary by macOS version. For a damaged-app or malware alert, see troubleshooting.

03 / THE THREE DISPLAYS

Start tuning in a minute

Connect your guitar, select the interface and the correct channel. Pluck one string at a time and mute the others.



1 Input level

Keep the signal in the useful range between MIN and MAX. If the meter warns in red, reduce input gain on the interface.

2 Analog needle

Left: too low, tune higher. Right: too high, tune lower. The centered needle and “In tune!” message indicate that the target is close.

3 String scale

String numbers are above the scale; note names and octaves are below. The turquoise marker follows measured pitch. The example shows string 5, A2.

04 / STANDARD AND DROP D

Strings, notes and cents

Choose your tuning in the instrument list. String numbering follows the usual convention: string 1 is the thinnest, highest-pitched string.

String	Standard	Drop D
6	**E2**	**D2**
5	**A2**	**A2**
4	**D3**	**D3**
3	**G3**	**G3**
2	**B3**	**B3**
1	**E4**	**E4**

What does the deviation mean?

100 cents is one semitone; 1200 cents is one octave. The needle displays ±50 cents. For larger deviations, the text gives the direction and an out-of-range message.

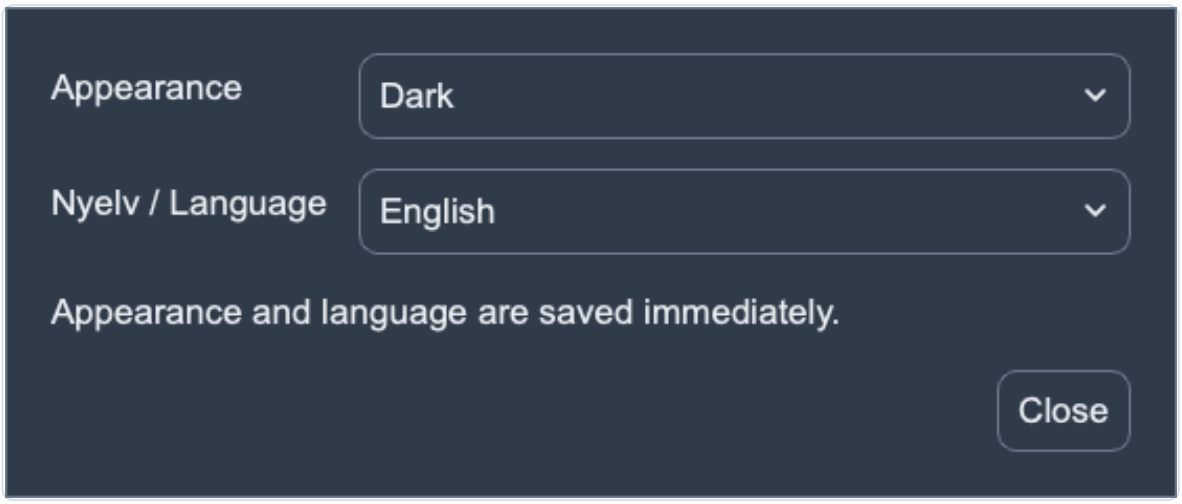
Example: lower a D3 string to C3

Measured note: C3. Nearest target: string 4, D3. The difference is about -200 cents, so “Too low” and “More than 50 cents away” are correct.

The target string is the nearest target in the selected tuning. Audio alone does not reliably identify which physical string you plucked. Check the string number and octave: E2 and E3 are different pitches.

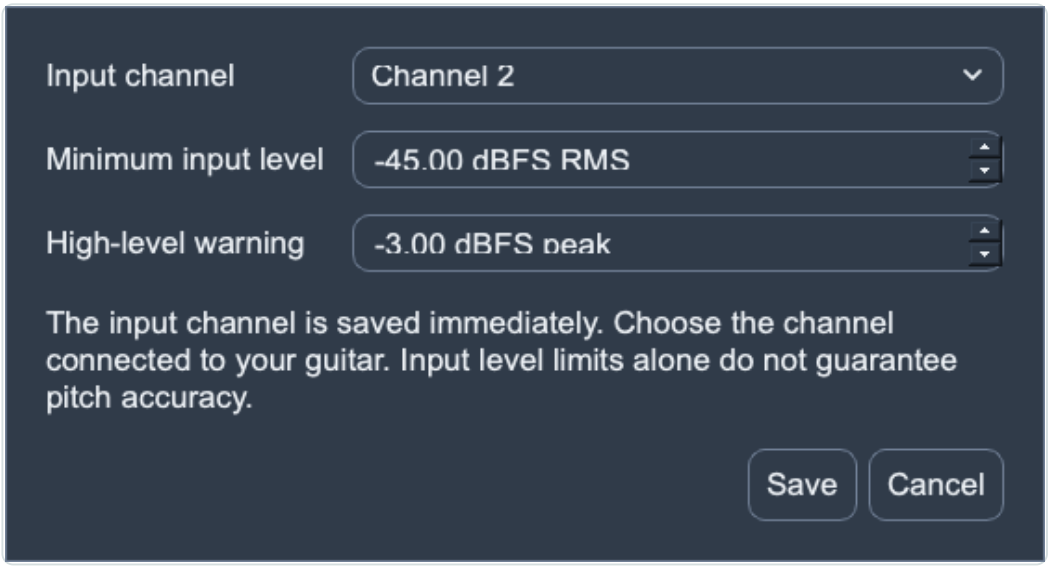
Make it your own

The top-right gear opens Settings, Audio and About.



Appearance and language

Light/Dark appearance and Magyar/English language apply and save immediately. Already open dialogs update too.



Choose the correct input channel

Select the channel connected to your guitar; it saves immediately per device. Use Save for the minimum/high-level warning thresholds. These controls do not change interface gain.

06 / QUICK TROUBLESHOOTING

If something is not working

No input signal or no detected note

Check the USB connection, selected device and channel. Set suitable interface gain. On macOS, also check microphone permission.

Red meter or input too loud

Reduce gain on the interface. Digital clipping clears the pitch display.
The tuner waits for a fresh window of clean audio before showing pitch again.

Unexpected note or octave

Check the tuning profile and pluck one string. Mute the others. Read measured pitch and target separately; the target shown is the nearest target note.

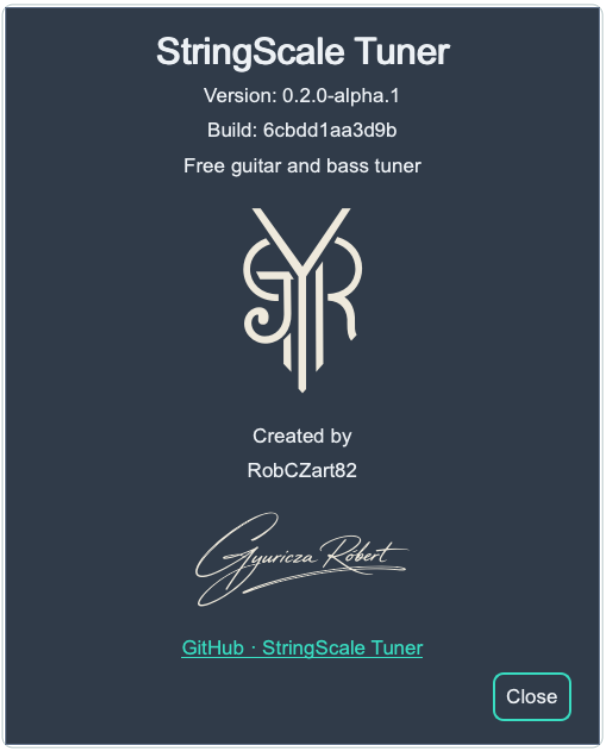
Brief dropout or disappearing needle

The app bridges brief uncertainty, but clears pitch for sustained silence, missing data or clipping. If blinking repeats, record the interface and build ID.

macOS: damaged-app or malware alert

This differs from an unidentified-developer warning. Download a fresh copy from the official page and verify its supplied SHA256. If it persists, report it to the project; do not disable system protection.

About and support



Include these in a bug report

- Version and Build from About
- Operating system and version
- Interface model and input channel
- Tuning profile and plucked string
- Actual and expected behavior
- A short screenshot/video if useful

Screenshots are illustrative test previews. Your About dialog shows the version and source ID of your downloaded build.

Project and downloads

GitHub / StringScale-Tuner

Releases and download packages

Issue tracker

What has been tested with a real guitar?

Mac mini M1 + SSL 2+ and Windows 10 + Behringer UCG-102: six standard strings and ±25–40 cent offsets were reported successful. Drop D and a larger pitch offset also received positive feedback. Other setups need separate testing.

Installation references

Apple / Open apps safely

Microsoft / SmartScreen reputation

System message wording can vary by operating-system version and language.